

How DHCP work

1

Discovery stage:

In the discovery stage, a client broadcasts a DHCP Discover message to locate available DHCP servers on the network.

2

Offer stage:

During the offer stage, DHCP servers respond to the client's Discover message with a DHCP Offer message, proposing an IP address lease along with other configuration parameters.

3

Request stage:

In the request stage, the client selects one of the offered IP addresses and sends a DHCP Request message to the chosen DHCP server, requesting the lease of the offered IP address.

4

Acknowledge stage:

In the acknowledge stage, the DHCP server acknowledges the client's request by sending a DHCP Acknowledge (ACK) message, confirming the allocation of the requested IP address and providing the client with additional configuration information.



D / O / R / A
(Discover / Offer / Request / Acknowledge)